

YILAN ANNIE GAO

annie.ylg@gmail.com | +1-804-244-2768 | linkedin.com/in/yilan-annie-gao

PMP · CSM · M.Ed. · M.P.I.

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- 12 years of strategy and operations experience leading high-impact, cross-functional programs from concept through scaled execution — consistently translating ambiguous business challenges into structured policy frameworks, operational systems, and measurable outcomes.
- Proven partner program operator with a track record of driving partner success, compliance scalability, and revenue protection — managing multi-million dollar program portfolios, 100% partner renewal rates, and GTM strategies that accelerate adoption and reduce risk.
- Deep cross-functional fluency across Product, Legal, Finance, and GTM — experienced developing and operationalizing policy frameworks, compliance protocols, and payment-related processes in partnership with legal and finance stakeholders.
- Hypothesis-driven problem solver who leads with data — designing analytical frameworks, operational dashboards, and proof-of-concept pilots that surface root causes, inform trade-offs, and drive durable business improvements.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Program Manager, Developer Relations | Roblox Corporation | San Mateo, CA *Feb 2023 – Present*

Partner Program Compliance & Policy Operations (2025–Present)

- Own compliance and policy strategy for Roblox's Top 1,000 partner accounts — developing and operationalizing policy frameworks, assessment protocols, and enforcement workflows in close partnership with Legal, Finance, Policy, and Engineering; represent partner impact and strategic trade-offs in VP- and C-suite decision meetings.
- Built the platform's first IP protection compliance system from zero — defining policy scope, partner assessment criteria, escalation protocols, and remediation workflows; reduced wrongful enforcement actions that threatened revenue integrity and partner trust.
- Drove GTM strategy and phased rollout of an IP protection product, partnering with Product and cross-functional teams on feature implementation and go-to-market adoption — managing competing stakeholder priorities and iterating on program design based on partner feedback and performance data.
- Resolved 600+ compliance cases in Q1, conducting root cause analyses that identified systemic program gaps and directly informed policy refinements, process improvements, and resource planning decisions.
- Lead payment dispute investigations for top creator cashout rejections — partnering with Finance and Legal to diagnose the underlying compliance or payment integrity issue, determine root cause, and bridge resolution communications between creators and internal teams; ensuring high-risk financial disputes are resolved accurately and in alignment with contractual and regulatory obligations.
- Manage 3 direct reports; synthesize program performance data into executive-level reports and strategic recommendations that shape program investment and operational priorities.

Business Operations & Program Scalability (2024)

- Program-managed 5 large-scale platform initiatives each reaching 10M+ users — leading full-cycle execution from scope definition and workstream planning through live delivery and post-program impact analysis; managed external vendor contracts and performance accountability.
- Designed and implemented operational reporting frameworks that translated complex performance data into clear executive readouts, trade-off analyses, and actionable recommendations for subsequent program cycles.
- Served as cross-functional integration lead across Product, Engineering, Legal, and GTM — driving alignment on scope, timeline, and resource trade-offs across competing priorities in a fast-paced environment.

GTM Strategy & Partner Ecosystem Operations (2023)

- Supported partner onboarding and ecosystem operations across international markets, designing tailored engagement strategies, compliance guidance, and scalable support frameworks for diverse partner segments.
- Co-designed a structured partner feedback system with the PMM team, embedding partner insights into the product development cycle upstream — ensuring program policies and product features reflected partner realities before launch.

Senior Program Manager, Developer Relations | Roblox China | Shenzhen, China *Mar 2021 – Feb 2023*

- Strategy and operations partner reporting to VP of DevRel China — led end-to-end GTM strategy for platform launch, including partner program design, compliance framework development, and performance reporting infrastructure; defined the operational model that enabled sustainable partner growth in a new market.

- Led cross-functional negotiation with the US Finance team to establish China's data access and financial reporting framework — aligning business strategy, regulatory obligations, and operational requirements across legal and finance stakeholders.
- Developed and operationalized executive reporting frameworks to track program health, partner performance, and risk indicators post-launch; delivered decision-ready briefings that directly influenced Global HQ resource allocation and investment decisions.
- Structured ambiguous local compliance and regulatory requirements into prioritized, actionable recommendations for global product and policy teams — ensuring program scalability across divergent regulatory environments.

Partnership Programs Lead | California State University, San Bernardino | San Bernardino, CA *Apr 2019 – Apr 2021*

- Managed a multi-partner program portfolio totaling \$4M+ in budget — achieving 100% program renewal rate and 60% partner growth in year one through proactive relationship management, compliance monitoring, and continuous program optimization.
- Designed and delivered 4 recurring end-to-end partner programs totaling 130+ instructional hours; led cross-functional strategic initiatives that produced a 23% improvement in partner engagement and measurable ROI gains across the portfolio.
- Developed partner assessment protocols and performance tracking frameworks to evaluate program health, identify at-risk relationships, and drive data-informed remediation strategies.

China Programs Coordinator | Virginia Commonwealth University | Richmond, VA *Jul 2014 – Mar 2019*

- Built and managed 5 international partnership programs achieving 300% enrollment growth; coordinated complex multi-stakeholder relationships across 10+ departments and 20+ institutional partners spanning diverse regulatory and contractual environments.

CERTIFICATIONS & SKILLS

Strategy & Business Operations: GTM Strategy · Partner Program Management · Policy Framework Development · Compliance Operationalization · Revenue Risk Mitigation · Cross-functional Leadership · Influencing Without Authority

Program Management: PMP (PMI) · Certified Scrum Master (CSM) · Agile · Scrum · Kanban · Waterfall · Scope Definition · Workstream Management · Executive Readouts

Analytics & Tools: SQL · Tableau · Excel (advanced) · Jira · Confluence · Google Suite · Flourish · Data Visualization · Dashboard Design

AI Tools: Claude · ChatGPT · Gemini — actively applied to workflow automation, operational reporting, and program analytics

EDUCATION

Master of Product Innovation — Virginia Commonwealth University *Dec 2018*

Master of Education — Adult Learning & Human Resource Development — Virginia Commonwealth University *May 2014*

Bachelor of Arts — English & International Relations — Sichuan International Studies University *Jul 2012*